

Requirement Card

REQ-01

NEW PRODUCT LAUNCH WEBSITE

TYPE: Growth

Requirement: Marketing is launching a flagship product this quarter and needs a modern public website.

Satisfied By: Web Server (7), OR web service hosted on a Cloud Workload (4)

Score Impact: Missed: **-5 points** (launch flops; lost sales)

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Requirement Card

REQ-02

CUSTOMER DATA ACQUISITION

TYPE: Growth / M&A

Requirement: The executive team is acquiring a customer-data company. Two million customer records must land somewhere safe by end of quarter.

Satisfied By: Database Server (10), OR database service hosted on a Cloud Workload (4) – cloud-hosting the crown jewels is a recorded risk

Score Impact: Missed: **-10 points** (deal falls through)

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Requirement Card

REQ-03

WORK-FROM-HOME PROGRAM

TYPE: Workforce

Requirement: HR is rolling out flexible work. Staff need secure remote access to internal systems.

Satisfied By: VPN Gateway (9)

Score Impact: Missed: **-3 points** (staff use risky workarounds; morale dips)

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Requirement Card

REQ-04

REMOTE WORKFORCE MANDATE

TYPE: Workforce

Requirement: The board mandates support for a fully remote workforce: secure access AND central identity for every remote login.

Satisfied By: VPN Gateway (9) AND Domain Controller (12)

Score Impact: Missed: **-5 points** (shadow IT spreads across home offices)

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Requirement Card

REQ-05

HIPAA COMPLIANCE MANDATE

TYPE: Compliance

Requirement: A new healthcare client puts you in HIPAA scope. Regulators expect recoverable data and isolated sensitive systems.

Satisfied By: Backup Server (9) AND network segmentation (Network Segmentation Switch (10), or Segmented/Fully Isolated architecture)

Score Impact: Missed: **-10 points** (client walks; compliance exposure)

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Requirement Card

REQ-06

PCI SCOPE: CARDHOLDER DATA

TYPE: Compliance

Requirement: You now process card payments. Cardholder data must live on a database that is walled off from the rest of the network.

Satisfied By: Database Server (10) or cloud-hosted database, AND a Firewall (12) or Network Segmentation Switch (10) protecting it

Score Impact: Missed: **-10 points** (acquirer threatens to pull card processing)

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REQ-07

99.9% UPTIME SLA

TYPE: Operations

Requirement: Your biggest customer signs a contract with a 99.9% uptime SLA on your public services. A single box is no longer good enough.

Satisfied By: Load Balancer (8), OR a second server duplicating any business-critical service (full price)

Score Impact: Missed: **-5 points** (SLA credits eat the margin)

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Requirement Card

REQ-08

M&A: INTEGRATE ACQUIRED NETWORK

TYPE: Growth / M&A

Requirement: The company you just bought needs its two core services absorbed into your infrastructure this quarter.

Satisfied By: Two free capacity slots across your existing servers, OR deploy any new server this turn to host them (overloading is allowed at +1 Budget per extra service)

Score Impact: Missed: **-10 points** (integration stalls; synergies evaporate)

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Requirement Card

REQ-09

SCALE EMAIL SYSTEM

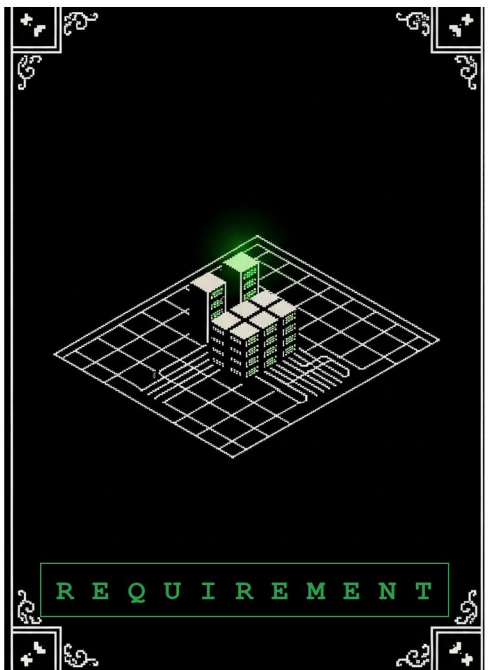
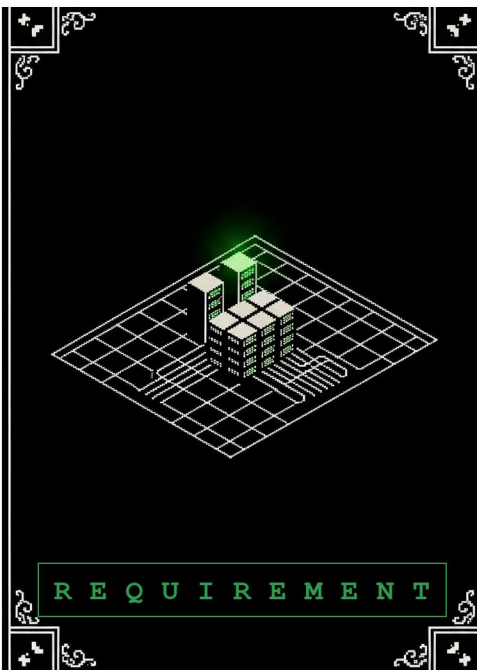
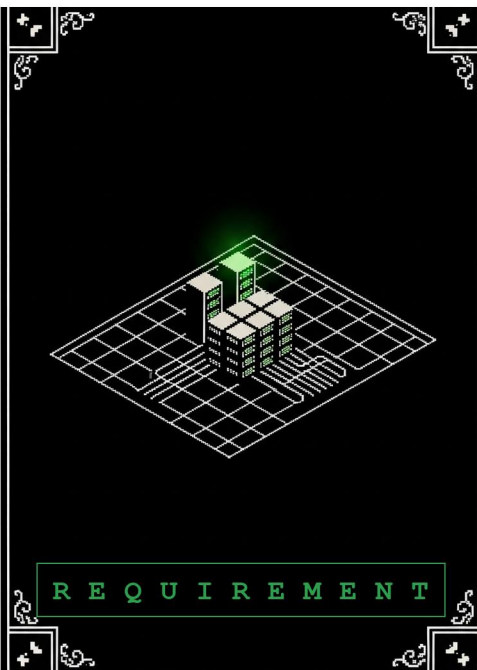
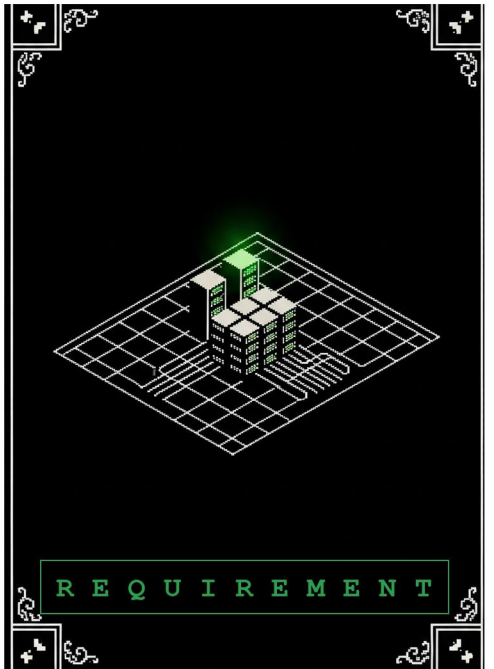
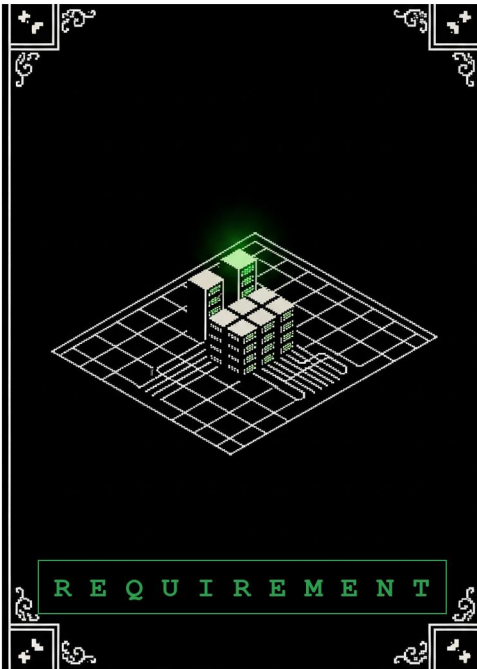
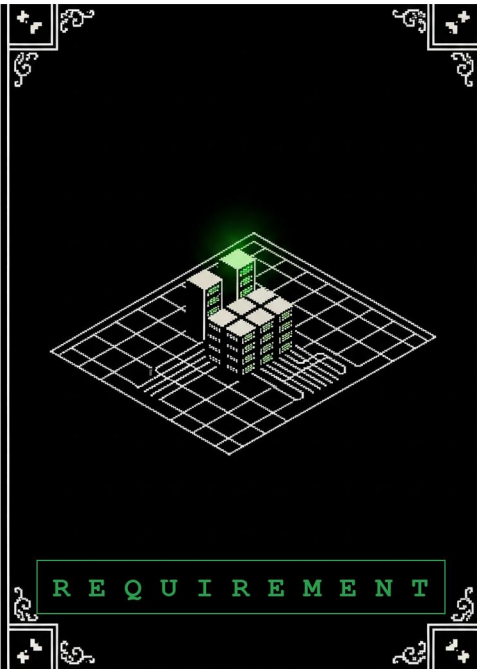
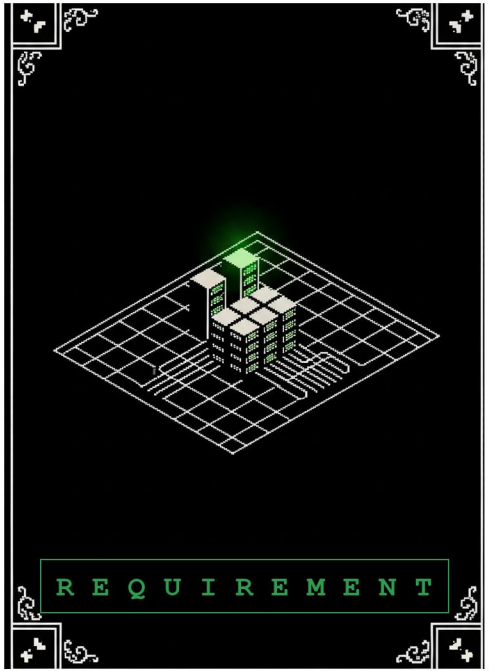
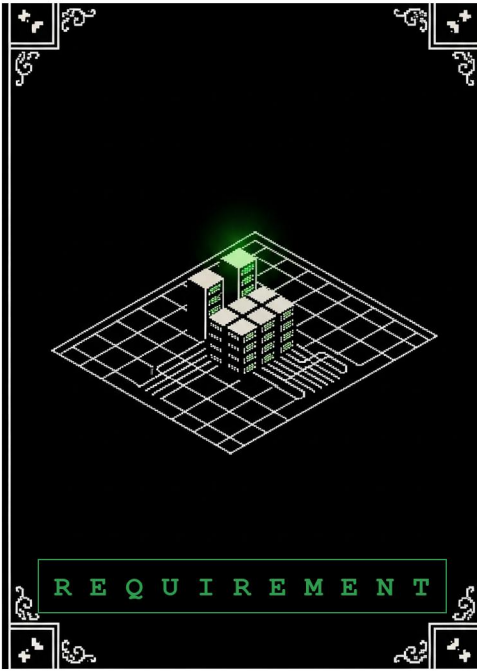
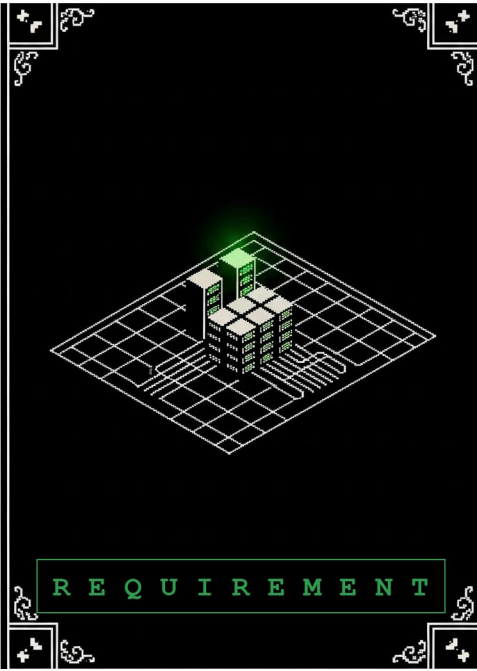
TYPE: Operations

Requirement: Headcount doubled and the email system is groaning. Add headroom.

Satisfied By: Second Email Server (8), Load Balancer (8), OR email hosted on a Cloud Workload (4)

Score Impact: Missed: **-5 points** (mail delays; missed customer requests)

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SECURITY AUDIT ORDERED

TYPE: Compliance

REQUIREMENT: The audit committee orders an independent security audit. Auditors expect centralized visibility of security events.

SATISFIED BY: SIEM (15), OR both IDS (10) and Email Gateway (6)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-5 points** (qualified audit opinion)

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BOARD DEMANDS IR READINESS

TYPE: Security

REQUIREMENT: A competitor's breach is front-page news. The board demands demonstrable incident-detection capability.

SATISFIED BY: IDS (10), IPS (14), OR SIEM (15)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-10 points** (board censure; CISO on thin ice)

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RANSOMWARE WAVE IN SECTOR

TYPE: Security

REQUIREMENT: A ransomware variant is tearing through your industry. You need recoverable backups AND a way to spot the attack.

SATISFIED BY: Backup Server (9) AND at least one of IDS (10) / IPS (14) / SIEM (15)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-20 points** (you are one bad click from catastrophe)

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NEW SUBSIDIARY OFFICE

TYPE: Growth

REQUIREMENT: A new regional office opens with no local infrastructure. Staff there must reach head-office systems securely.

SATISFIED BY: VPN Gateway (9)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-5 points** (office runs on personal email and USB sticks)

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E-COMMERCE EXPANSION

TYPE: Growth

REQUIREMENT: Sales moves online. You need a public web presence AND protection against the web attacks that come with taking payments.

SATISFIED BY: Web Server (7) or cloud-hosted web, AND WAF (11)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-5 points** (checkout is either absent or a breach waiting to happen)

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DEVELOPER HIRING SPREE

TYPE: Workforce

REQUIREMENT: Engineering triples in size. Developers need somewhere to build and test that is not production.

SATISFIED BY: Development Server (5), OR dev services overloaded onto an existing server (+1 Budget per extra service – allowed)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-3 points** (developers test in production; incidents follow)

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RECORDS-RETENTION REGULATION

TYPE: Compliance

REQUIREMENT: New regulation requires seven-year retention of business records: durable shared storage plus a recoverable copy.

SATISFIED BY: File storage (File Server (6), or hosted on another server's capacity/overload) AND Backup Server (9)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-5 points** (regulator issues a compliance notice)

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SINGLE SIGN-ON ROLLOUT

TYPE: Operations

REQUIREMENT: Password chaos across a dozen apps. Leadership wants one identity for everything.

SATISFIED BY: Domain Controller (12)

SCORE IMPACT: Missed: **-5 points** (password reuse everywhere; helpdesk drowning)

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CYBER-INSURANCE RENEWAL

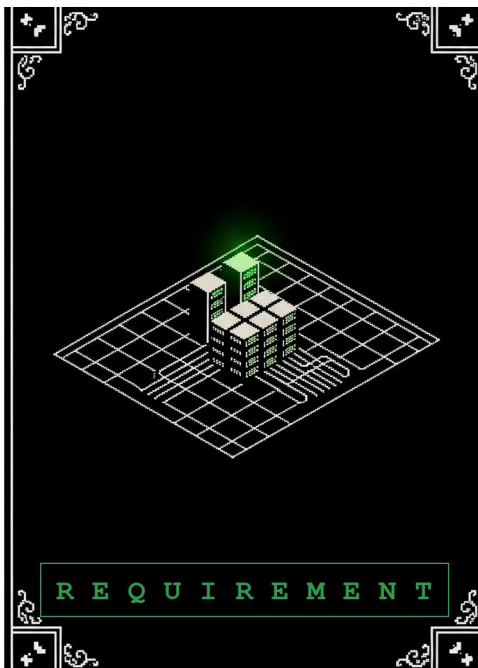
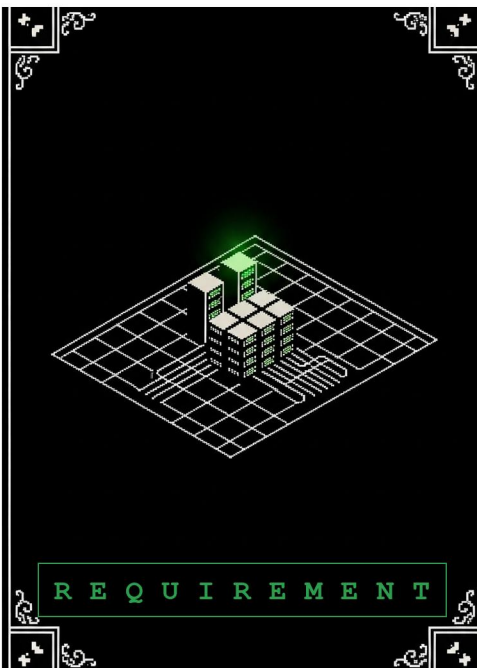
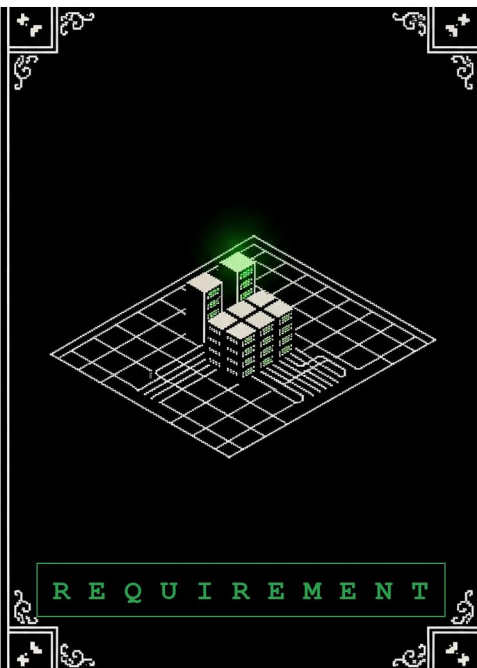
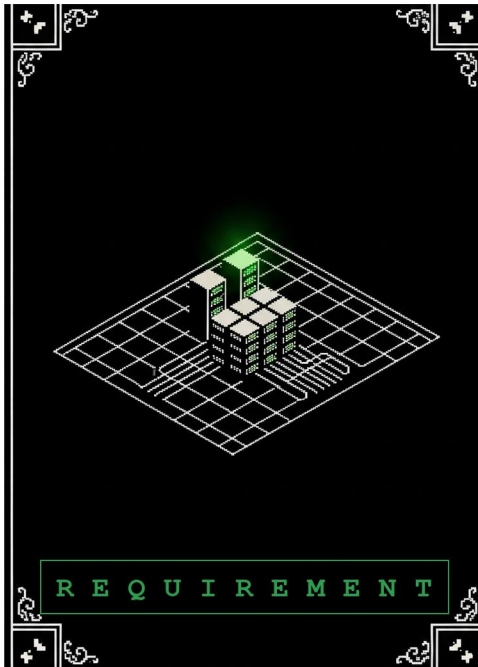
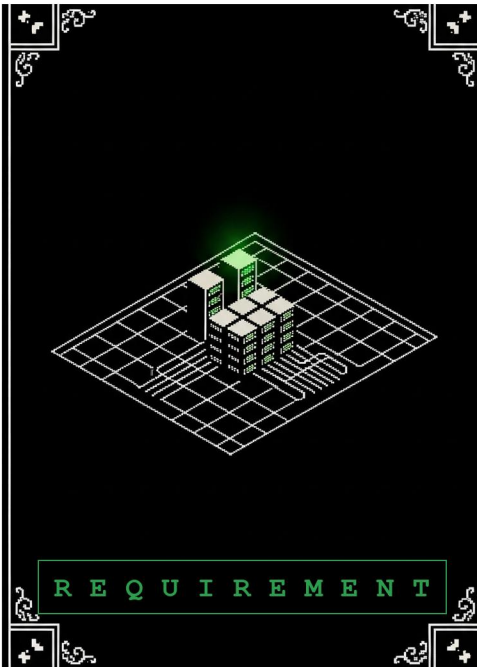
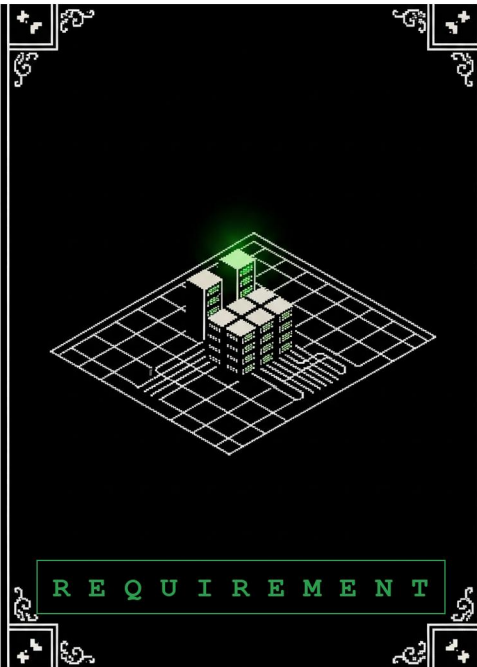
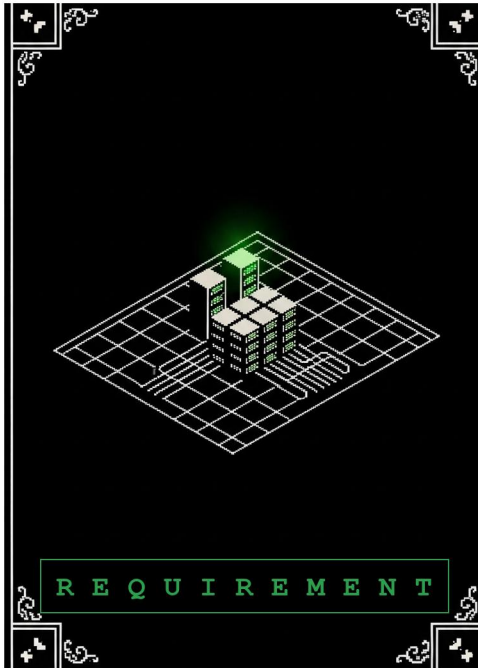
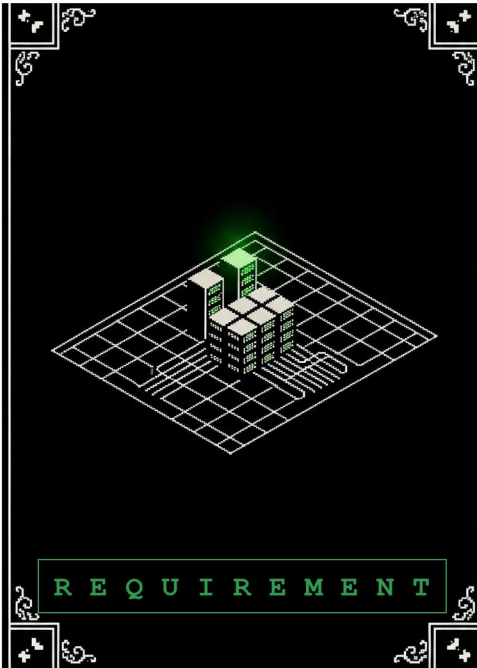
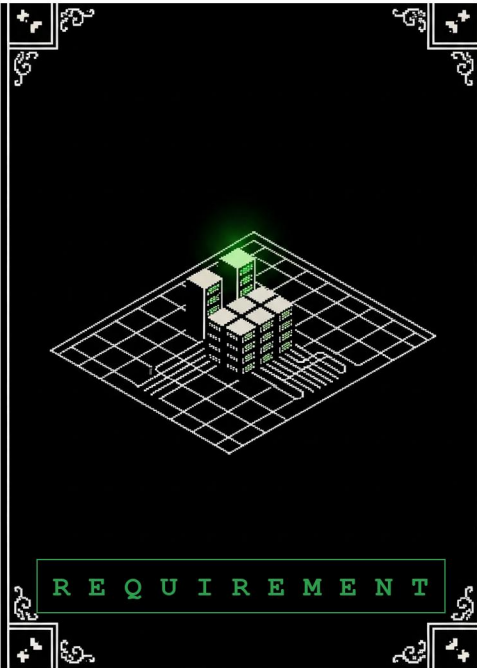
TYPE: Security

REQUIREMENT: Your insurer's renewal questionnaire wants proof of backups, phishing defense, and detection.

SATISFIED BY: Backup Server (9) AND Email Gateway (6) AND at least one of IDS/IPS/SIEM

SCORE IMPACT: Met: **+5 points** (premium drops). Missed: **-5 points** (premium spikes)

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THREAT-INTEL PILOT

TYPE: Security (Opportunity)

REQUIREMENT: Your ISAC offers to feature any member running deception technology in its quarterly report.

SATISFIED BY: Honeypot Decoy (7) or Honeypot Network (8)

SCORE IMPACT: Met: ****+5 points**** (industry kudos). Missed: ****0 points**** (opportunity passes; no penalty)

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DATA-CENTER CONSOLIDATION

TYPE: Operations (Opportunity)

REQUIREMENT: Finance wants the server-room footprint shrunk. Show that at least one business service runs in the cloud.

SATISFIED BY: Any service hosted on a Cloud Workload (4)

SCORE IMPACT: Met: ****+3 points**** (opex savings). Missed: ****−3 points**** (facilities costs balloon)

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EMAIL SERVER FAILURE

TYPE: Outage

EFFECT: Your email server dies mid-quarter. Choose one:

MITIGATED BY: A second Email Server, or email hosted on a Cloud Workload – the redundant/cloud service carries the load: no cost, no penalty

– Repair: Pay 5 Budget (emergency callout) – Ignore: **−10 points** (email down all quarter; users furious)

No email service at all? Nothing to break – but you already have bigger problems (see Capability scoring)

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TRAFFIC SPIKE

TYPE: Load

EFFECT: Your product goes viral overnight. Public services are hammered.

MITIGATED BY: Load Balancer (8), CDN (expansion CLOUD-04), or redundant web hosting

– Prepared (Load Balancer, CDN, or a duplicated web service): **+5 points** (you rode the wave; sales boom) – Unprepared: **−5 points** (site down during your biggest day)

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PHISHING WAVE

TYPE: Attack

EFFECT: A targeted phishing campaign hits every inbox in the company.

MITIGATED BY: Email Gateway (6)

– Email Gateway deployed: **+5 points** (campaign filtered; nice catch) – No Email Gateway: **−10 points** (three credential sets stolen)

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CLOUD VENDOR OUTAGE

TYPE: Outage

EFFECT: Your cloud provider has a region-wide outage this quarter.

MITIGATED BY: On-prem redundancy for cloud-hosted services, or an all-on-prem design

LESSON: Cloud is cheap, but concentration risk is real

– If any required business service runs only in the cloud: **−5 points** (service dark; SLA breached) – Cloud services with an on-prem twin, or no cloud usage: no effect

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BUDGET CUT

TYPE: Finance

EFFECT: Fiscal crisis. ****Lose 5 Budget immediately**** (to a minimum of 0).

MITIGATED BY: Nothing – but teams holding a contingency reserve absorb it without changing plans

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EMERGENCY FUNDS

TYPE: Finance

EFFECT: A surprise rebate lands. ****Gain +10 Budget**** (one time).

MITIGATED BY: N/A (enjoy it)

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SECURITY GRANT

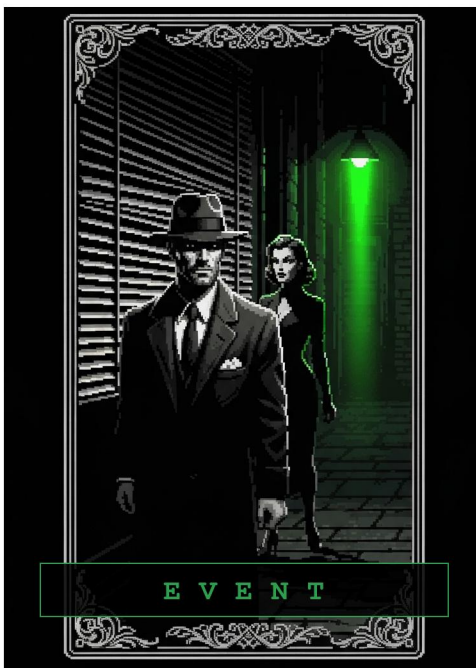
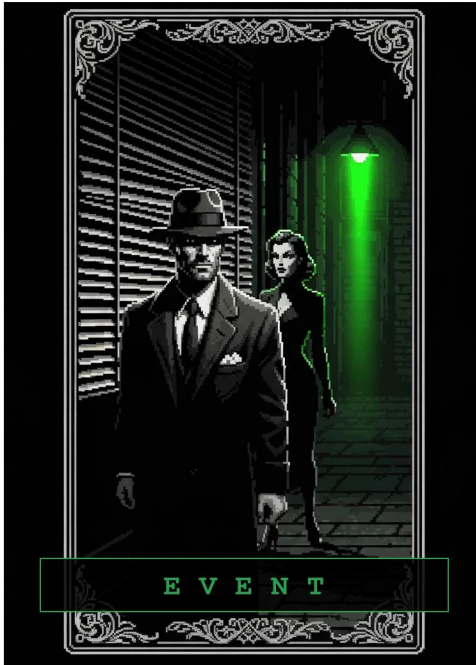
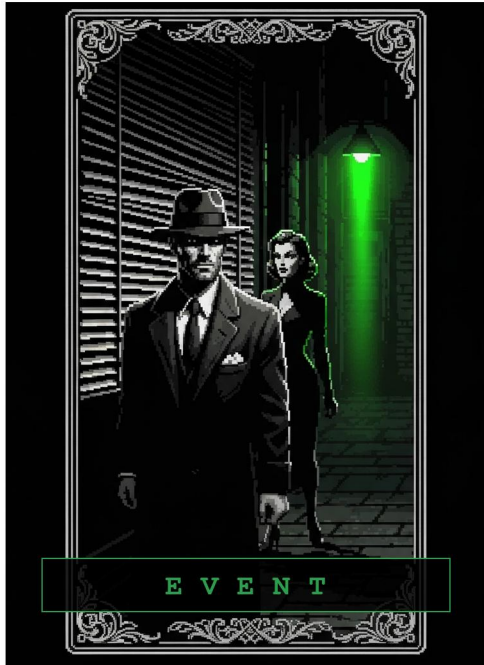
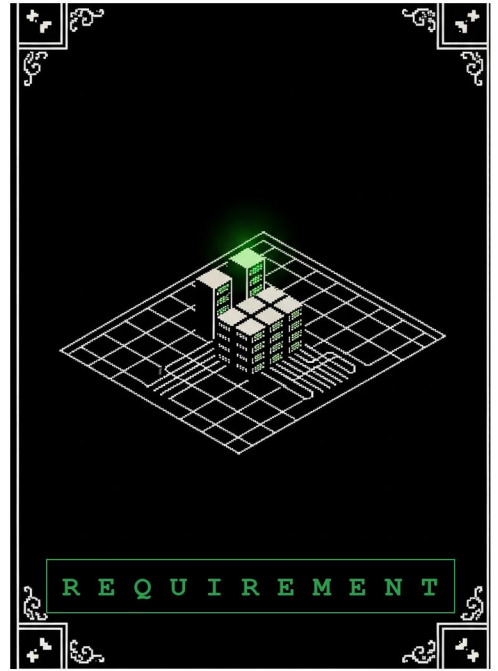
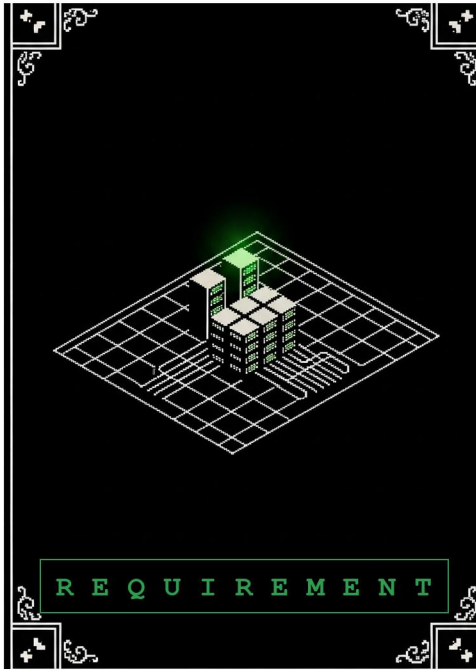
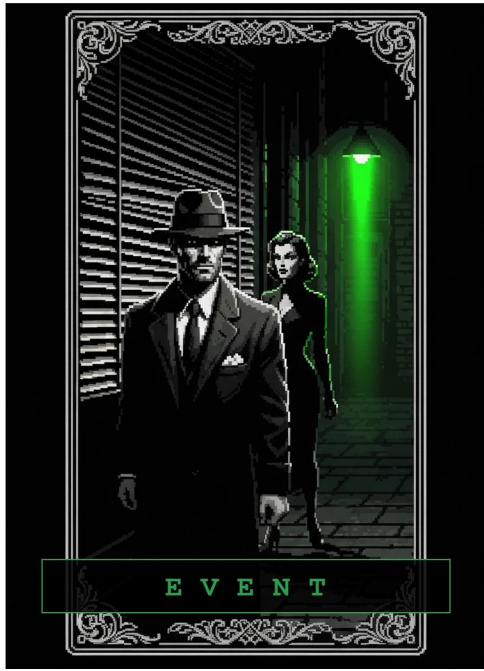
TYPE: Finance

EFFECT: A government cyber-resilience grant is available to organizations with recoverable backups.

MITIGATED BY: N/A – this one rewards good hygiene

– Backup Server deployed: Gain **+5 Budget**
– No Backup Server: Nothing (you don't qualify)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-08

FILE SERVER FILLING UP

TYPE: Capacity**EFFECT:** Shared storage hits 98% full.
Choose one this turn:**MITIGATED BY:** Spare capacity anywhere in
your design (assign file
storage to it at no cost)

– Add capacity: Deploy any server to host
file storage, or overload an existing
server (+1 Budget per extra service) –
Ignore: –5 points (service degradation;
work grinds)

No file storage service at all? No effect
– and no file-storage capability either

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EVENT CARD

EVT-09

HONEYPOT TRIGGERS

TYPE: Attack (Detected?)**EFFECT:** Someone has been quietly probing
your network.**MITIGATED BY:** N/A – this is deception's
payday

– Honeypot Decoy or Honeypot Network
deployed: +5 points (intruder caught
red-handed in the decoy; access cut) – No
honeypot: Nothing visible happens.
Nothing visible *ever* happens. (No
penalty – this time)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-10

INSIDER SNOOPING

TYPE: Attack**EFFECT:** An employee is browsing systems
far outside their role.**MITIGATED BY:** SIEM (15) or Network
Segmentation Switch (10) /
segmented architecture

– SIEM deployed OR network segmentation
in place: +5 points (caught early /
blocked at the zone boundary) – Neither:
–5 points (months of quiet data access
before anyone notices)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-11

RANSOMWARE STRIKES

TYPE: Attack (Severe)**EFFECT:** Ransomware detonates on an
internal system.**MITIGATED BY:** Backup Server (9); detection
reduces blast radius

– Backup Server deployed: Pay 3 Budget
for restore effort; if you also have
detection (IDS/IPS/SIEM), you contained
it fast: +5 points – No Backup Server:
–20 points (pay the ransom or lose the
data – either way it's ugly)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-12

IT STAFF BURNOUT

TYPE: Operations**EFFECT:** The ops team is running on fumes.
**This turn you may deploy at most
ONE component.** (Handling the
turn's Business Requirement with
an already-deployed component is
fine.)**MITIGATED BY:** Designs that are already
complete – teams who
front-loaded their build
barely notice

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EVENT CARD

EVT-13

VENDOR PROMOTION

TYPE: Opportunity**EFFECT:** A security vendor is clearing
stock. **The next security device
you deploy this turn costs 2
less** (minimum cost 1).**MITIGATED BY:** N/A – pure opportunity; skip
it if nothing on the list
fits your design

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EVENT CARD

EVT-14

NEW HIRE NEEDS REMOTE ACCESS

TYPE: Workforce**EFFECT:** A key new hire works from another
city and starts Monday.**MITIGATED BY:** VPN Gateway (9)

– VPN Gateway deployed: No effect
(onboarding is routine) – No VPN Gateway:
–3 points (they quit in week two, or
worse: they improvise)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-15

HARDWARE RECALL

TYPE: Outage**EFFECT:** A vendor recalls a faulty
component. Pick one of your
on-prem servers (Threat
Orchestrator picks if you won't):**MITIGATED BY:** Redundant servers or
cloud-hosted twins (the twin
covers the outage: no cost,
no penalty). All-cloud
designs are unaffected

– Pay 3 Budget for expedited replacement,
OR – That server is offline this quarter
– any requirement it alone satisfies
counts as unmet this turn

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EVENT CARD

EVT-16

QUIET QUARTER

TYPE: Respite**EFFECT:** Nothing breaks. Nobody attacks.
Finance leaves you alone. Use the
breathing room to review your
gaps.**MITIGATED BY:** N/A

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